ILLUSTRATION · SYNTHETIC CONGESTION AND WEATHER TO SHOW EVERY STATUS · NOT A REAL FORECAST

PORT·BRIEF

Freight intelligence for UK forwarders, importers & logistics managers

Wednesday 30 September 2026
Forecast run 2026-09-30 16:21 UTC

Felixstowe congested and London Gateway wind stoppage likely Saturday

Action needed at Felixstowe (congested), London Gateway (disruption likely), Liverpool (watch), Rotterdam (watch). Inbound: weather may delay transatlantic and Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel by up to 1 day. Reliability: Sea-Intelligence 49.9%, Xeneta 29%.

PORTS NEEDING ACTION	INBOUND DELAY RISK	RELIABILITY · SEA-INTELLIGENCE	RELIABILITY · XENETA
6 / 8	**2**	**49.9%**	**29%**
UK & North European gateways	lanes, worst: Western Approaches	Aug 2026 · -5.9 pp m/m	Aug 2026 · -4.0 pp m/m

PORT STATUS · WHAT TO DO THIS WEEK

UK gateways

Felixstowe — ■ CONGESTED

Berth occupancy 84%, 13 pp above normal. Add 2–3 days to inland plans for containers arriving in the next 2 weeks, pre-book haulage and check your free time.

Berth occupancy 84% (+13 pp vs normal) · median 38 h in port · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Southampton — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

Running as expected with no predicted delays. Speak to your carrier about release and delivery now to keep it that way.

Berth occupancy 61% (+1 pp vs normal) · median 22 h in port · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

London Gateway — ◆ DISRUPTION LIKELY

Crane stoppages likely Sat 3 Oct 11:00–20:00 with gusts to 22 m/s. Tell your haulier to expect longer waits and allow 24–48 hours on collections.

Berth occupancy 66% (+2 pp vs normal) · median 25 h in port · Weather: Sat 3 Oct 11:00–20:00

Liverpool — ▲ WATCH

Intermittent crane stoppages possible Sun 4 Oct 07:00–13:00. Allow 12–24 hours and avoid tight Sunday cut-offs.

Berth occupancy 58% (-3 pp vs normal) · median 20 h in port · Weather: Sun 4 Oct 07:00–13:00

North European hubs

Rotterdam — ▲ WATCH

Busier than usual at 7 pp above normal occupancy. Keep an eye on berthing times if you tranship here and avoid tight feeder connections.

Berth occupancy 74% (+7 pp vs normal) · median 31 h in port · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Antwerp — ● RUNNING NORMALLY

Running as expected with no predicted delays. Speak to your carrier about release and delivery now.

Berth occupancy 63% (+0 pp vs normal) · median 28 h in port · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Bremerhaven — ■ CONGESTED

Ships spending 36% longer in port than usual. Add 2–3 days to inland plans for containers arriving in the next 2 weeks and pre-book haulage.

Berth occupancy 70% (+4 pp vs normal) · median 45 h in port · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

Hamburg — ◆ DISRUPTION LIKELY

Reported 24-hour strike on Monday. Check your terminal's latest notice before booking collections and allow 24–48 hours.

Berth occupancy 68% (+3 pp vs normal) · median 30 h in port · No crane or pilotage limits forecast

● Running normally ▲ Watch ■ Congested ◆ Disruption likely · Weather windows in UK time. Congestion vs normal: Sinay berth occupancy compared with that port's usual level.

PORTS · SIX-DAY WEATHER OUTLOOK

Crane and pilotage conditions

Felixstowe: congested. London Gateway: disruption likely. Liverpool: watch. Rotterdam: watch. Bremerhaven: congested. Hamburg: disruption likely. 2 of 8 ports are running normally.

PORT	WED 30	THU 01	FRI 02	SAT 03	SUN 04	MON 05	TUE 06	OCCUPANCY
Felixstowe	8 · 0.7	10 · 0.4	8 · 0.4	7 · 0.4	6 · 0.4	8 · 0.3	10 · 0.3	84% (13)
Southampton	11 · 0.9	10 · 0.9	8 · 0.6	6 · 0.3	7 · 0.3	8 · 0.3	13 · 0.3	61% (1)
London Gateway	9 · 0.4	10 · 0.3	10 · 0.3	8 · 0.2	8 · 0.3	9 · 0.3	12 · 0.3	66% (2)
Liverpool	7 · 0.6	12 · 0.7	14 · 1.0	8 · 1.0	8 · 1.1	11 · 0.8	12 · 1.0	58% (-3)
Rotterdam	9 · 0.5	11 · 0.6	6 · 0.4	6 · 0.3	9 · 0.8	9 · 0.8	11 · 0.7	74% (7)
Antwerp	10 · 0.5	11 · 0.6	8 · 0.5	5 · 0.2	6 · 0.6	7 · 0.7	10 · 0.6	63% (0)
Bremerhaven	9 · 0.6	9 · 0.6	7 · 0.3	7 · 0.6	9 · 1.4	10 · 1.4	11 · 1.3	70% (4)
Hamburg	9 · 0.7	9 · 0.7	6 · 0.3	8 · 0.9	11 · 1.7	12 · 1.7	12 · 1.5	68% (3)

Cells: peak gust m/s · peak sea m (UTC days). ▲ Watch ◆ Likely — crane stoppages from gusts ≥ 15 / 20 m/s; pilot boarding from sea ≥ 2.5 / 3.5 m or long-period swell. Occupancy: Sinay berth occupancy (gap vs port's usual level, pp).

ON THE WAY IN · LANES & CHOKEPOINTS

Weather that could delay your arrivals

Western Approaches: Expect transatlantic and Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel to run up to 1 day late. Don't book haulage against the published ETA; confirm the revised ETA with your carrier. Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas: Expect Asia–North Europe services routed via the Cape to run up to 1 day late. Don't book haulage against the published ETA; confirm the revised ETA with your carrier.

RISK	LANE	AFFECTS	WHEN	EXPECTED DELAY
▲ WATCH	Western Approaches	transatlantic and Cape-routed Asia arrivals into the Channel	Thu 1 Oct	**up to 1 day**
▲ WATCH	Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas	Asia–North Europe services routed via the Cape	Tue 6 Oct	**up to 1 day**

Lanes with flagged days: Western Approaches (Thu 1 Oct).

LANE	WED 30	THU 01	FRI 02	SAT 03	SUN 04	MON 05	TUE 06
Dover Strait	0.8 · 6	0.9 · 9	0.7 · 7	0.3 · 5	0.6 · 6	0.5 · 7	0.4 · 7
Western Approaches	3.9 · 10	▲ 4.9 · 10	3.8 · 9	2.3 · 5	1.5 · 3	1.3 · 6	1.8 · 6
Bay of Biscay	3.6 · 12	3.9 · 10	3.6 · 8	2.4 · 9	1.8 · 10	1.5 · 10	1.3 · 7
German Bight	0.8 · 8	0.8 · 10	0.4 · 6	1.0 · 7	1.8 · 9	1.8 · 9	1.6 · 9
Strait of Gibraltar	0.9 · 2	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 9	1.0 · 8	1.0 · 9	1.0 · 5	0.8 · 3
Mid-North Atlantic	3.8 · 13	3.6 · 12	2.8 · 8	2.3 · 6	1.5 · 8	1.4 · 5	1.7 · 9
Cape of Good Hope / Agulhas	3.4 · 13	3.3 · 11	2.5 · 11	2.6 · 10	2.7 · 13	2.7 · 9	▲ 4.0 · 14
Suez approaches (Port Said)	1.0 · 7	0.8 · 6	0.6 · 8	0.5 · 6	0.5 · 4	0.4 · 6	0.4 · 4

Bab-el-Mandeb / Gulf of Aden	0.8 · 9	0.8 · 7	0.9 · 9	1.2 · 9	1.3 · 10	1.1 · 9	1.1 · 9
Arabian Sea	1.1 · 1	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 4	1.1 · 5	1.0 · 4	0.9 · 3	0.9 · 2
South of Sri Lanka	1.6 · 7	1.7 · 6	1.6 · 4	1.5 · 4	1.4 · 4	1.3 · 3	1.3 · 2
Strait of Malacca	0.2 · 5	0.1 · 5	0.1 · 4	0.1 · 4	0.1 · 6	0.0 · 4	0.1 · 3
Taiwan Strait	0.3 · 3	0.4 · 8	1.6 · 12	1.4 · 10	0.9 · 8	3.2 · 16	3.2 · 15
Panama approaches (Colón)	1.0 · 4	1.0 · 6	0.9 · 4	0.8 · 6	0.7 · 5	0.7 · 5	0.6 · 4

Cells: peak sea m · peak wind m/s. ▲ Watch (sea ≥ 4 m or gale) ◆ Likely (sea ≥ 6 m or severe gale). Agulhas also flags south-west swell against the current.

Forecast drift since the last run

WHERE	DAY	GUST	SEA
Hamburg	Mon 5 Oct	15→12	1.7→1.7

Tropical cyclones

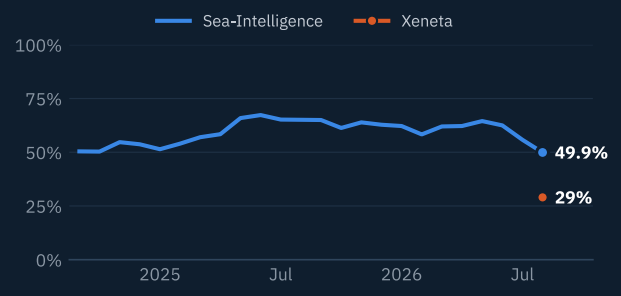
STORM	STRENGTH	NEAREST TRACKED
NOLO-26	Tropical Storm	none within 1,200 km
RACHEL-26	Hurricane/Typhoon > 74 mph	none within 1,200 km
HANNA-26	Tropical Depression	none within 1,200 km
NINETEEN-E-26	Tropical Depression	none within 1,200 km
TWENTYSIX-26	Tropical Storm	none within 1,200 km

SCHEDULE RELIABILITY · MONTHLY, ~4–6 WEEKS LAGGED

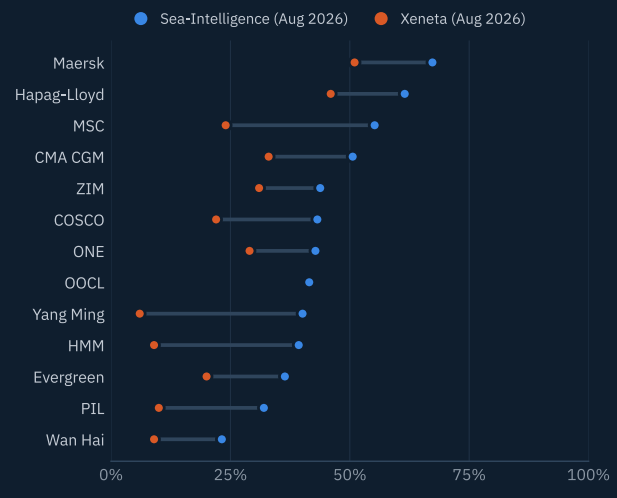
Two benchmarks, two definitions of on time

Sea-Intelligence: 49.9% on time in 2026-08 (-5.9 pp month on month). Xeneta: 29% for 2026-08. The two benchmarks sit 20.9 pp apart because they define 'on time' differently; read them as two views of the same trend, not as a contradiction.

Global on-time share



Carriers: same month, two methods



CARRIER	SEA-INTELLIGENCE AUG 2026	RANK	XENETA AUG 2026	RANK	GAP
Maersk	67.3%	1	51%	1	+16.3 pp
Hapag-Lloyd	61.5%	2	46%	2	+15.5 pp
MSC	55.2%	3	24%	6	+31.2 pp
CMA CGM	50.6%	4	33%	3	+17.6 pp
ZIM	43.8%	5	31%	4	+12.8 pp
COSCO	43.2%	6	22%	7	+21.2 pp
ONE	42.8%	7	29%	5	+13.8 pp
OOCL	41.5%	8	–		
Yang Ming	40.1%	9	6%	12	+34.1 pp
HMM	39.3%	10	9%	11	+30.3 pp
Evergreen	36.4%	11	20%	8	+16.4 pp
PIL	32.0%	12	10%	9	+22.0 pp
Wan Hai	23.2%	13	9%	10	+14.2 pp

Sea-Intelligence: Share of vessel arrivals within one day of scheduled arrival; 34 trade lanes, 60+ carriers (GLP report). Average delay for late arrivals 6.81 days.

Xeneta: Share of vessel arrivals on the scheduled day (eeSea data); Xeneta Ocean Benchmark. Xeneta ranks 12 carriers (OOCL is not listed separately).

Gap = Sea-Intelligence minus Xeneta, percentage points. Different definitions of 'on time' and different vessel samples; the gap is expected and is itself informative.

PORT & CARRIER NOTICES · PAST SEVEN DAYS

Advisories

Operational notices from the past week from the ports and carriers we follow. Items marked NEW did not appear in a previous issue.

Ports

NEW Peel Ports announced weekly Greenock to Rotterdam service · Port of Liverpool (Peel Ports) · 2026-09-25 · container-news.com

NEW Peel Ports reinstates weekly Greenock-Rotterdam container service · Port of Liverpool (Peel Ports) · 2026-09-24 · Container Management

NEW Port of Rotterdam adds electricity grid capacity in Europoort · Port of Rotterdam · 2026-09-28 · container-news.com

NEW Rotterdam Temporary Transformer Could Ease Port Grid Limits · Port of Rotterdam · 2026-09-28 · environmentenergyleader.com

NEW Port of Rotterdam to gain 500MW of temporary grid capacity · Port of Rotterdam · 2026-09-25 · Port Technology

NEW Kazakhstan, Belgium's Antwerp Port explore new routes for Middle Corridor · Port of Antwerp-Bruges · 2026-09-28 · trend.az

Carriers

NEW Maersk implements USD 500 peak season surcharge on South America-Europe routes · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · Data Portuaria

NEW Maersk, KTZ Express seek to expand joint service on TITR, other sea routes · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · trend.az

NEW Maersk implements peak season surcharge on Europe-South Africa route · Maersk · 2026-09-30 · Data Portuaria

NEW MSC announces new Far East to Europe FAK rates · MSC · 2026-09-29 · container-news.com

NEW MSC introduces surcharge from Europe to Middle East · MSC · 2026-09-29 · container-news.com

NEW Hapag-Lloyd to resume Suez transits for India-USEC service: sources · Hapag-Lloyd · 2026-09-30 · Journal of Commerce

NEW Hapag-Lloyd GRI: South America East Coast Rates Rise November 2026 - News and Statistics · Hapag-Lloyd · 2026-09-30 · IndexBox

NEW Hapag-Lloyd's Planned Purchase of ZIM Integrated Shipping Services Faces Opposition from Israel · Hapag-Lloyd · 2026-09-29 · marketscreener.com

NEW CMA CGM raises Asia–Mediterranean FAK rates · CMA CGM · 2026-09-30 · container-news.com

NEW CMA CGM backs down on promise to register 40 ships under the French flag amid threat of windfall tax on profits · CMA CGM · 2026-09-30 · Le Monde.fr

NEW CMA CGM adds reefer surcharge from South America to North Europe · CMA CGM · 2026-09-30 · container-news.com

Sources, method & data health

Weather is treated as a leading indicator: flags mark days when forecast wind or sea state reach levels at which crane work or pilot boarding is commonly suspended, or heavy weather slows transits. They are probabilistic signals, not port notices; always confirm with your terminal or carrier.

Headlines link to the original publishers; some discovered via Google News. Port congestion data: Sinay (sinay.ai). Schedule reliability: Sea-Intelligence Global Liner Performance report; Xeneta Schedule Reliability Scorecard. Tropical cyclone data: GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), European Commission JRC / UN OCHA. Weather data by Open-Meteo.com (CC BY 4.0).

Data health this run: marine weather **ok** · cyclones **ok** · sinay congestion **skipped** · schedule reliability **ok** · advisories **ok**.